



Plants for urban gardens

Sheltered by a blockade of tall buildings, city gardens are warmer year-round than more rural plots, broadening your choice of plants.

Plants, such as Peruvian lily, that often suffer in winter sail through unscathed in snug city enclaves. Pollution, rubble-filled soils, and lack of privacy are the main problems for urban gardeners, but all of these can be overcome by digging out the debris and by planting strategically. Line the boundaries with well-behaved shrubs, such as ninebark and lilac, to shield your space from prying eyes, and fill flowerbeds with tough, colorful plants, or create an elegant monotone scheme. In tiny plots, restrict your palette to just a few species to produce a more cohesive design.



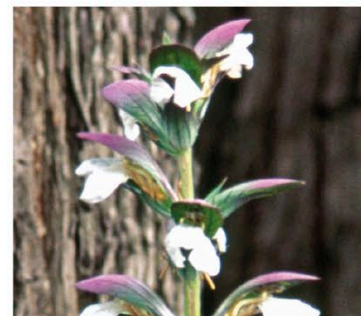
SHRUB LARGE

Abutilon hybrids

FLOWERING MAPLE These upright deciduous shrubs have narrow, lobed, gray-green felted foliage. From late spring to early summer, they bear flowers in many soft tones. Grow near a south-facing wall. Suitable as annuals in colder climates.

↑12ft (4m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀ Z9–10



PERENNIAL LARGE

Acanthus mollis

COMMON BEAR'S BREECHES An upright perennial with large, deeply lobed dark green foliage and tall sturdy spikes of hooded white and pale purple flowers from mid- to late summer. The decorative leaves extend the season of interest.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z7–11



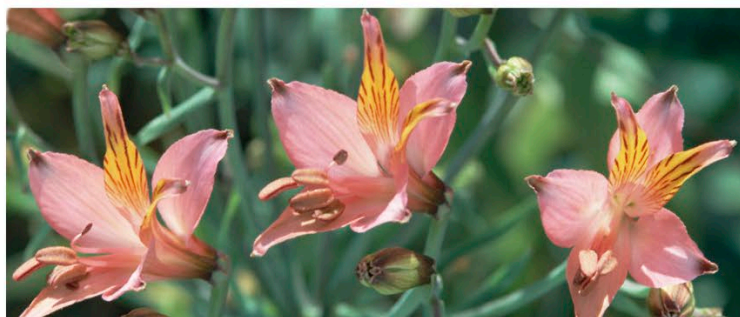
TREE LARGE

Acer rubrum 'October Glory'

RED MAPLE The glossy dark green leaves of this deciduous spreading tree turn deep red in fall, particularly on neutral to acidic soil. In spring, the bare branches are covered with tiny red flower clusters. Best in open areas as shallow roots can crack sidewalks.

↑70ft (20m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀ Բ Z3–9 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Alstroemeria ligtu hybrids

PERUVIAN LILY An upright rhizome-forming perennial with lance-shaped gray-green leaves and funnel-shaped flowers in a range of showy colors that appear in summer and are ideal for cutting. Plant it in groups in a sheltered spot; mulch in winter.

↑24in (60cm)

☀ ! Z8–11



TREE SMALL

Amelanchier laevis

ALLEGHENY SERVICEBERRY A small, upright deciduous tree with purple-tinted young leaves that mature to dark green, then turn orange-red in fall. The white flowers in spring are followed by round edible berries in summer.

↑↔25ft (8m)

☀ Բ Z4–8 (N)



SHRUB LARGE

Amelanchier lamarckii

JUNE BERRY This small, upright deciduous tree or large shrub has bronze-tinted young leaves that are dark green when mature, and orange and red in fall. White flowers in spring are followed by red to purple berries that are loved by birds.

↑15ft (5m) ↔20ft (6m)

☀ Բ Z4–8 (N)



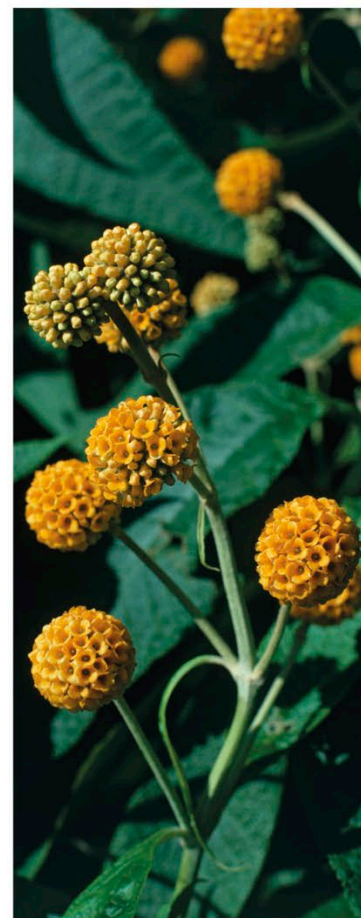
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Artemisia ludoviciana 'Silver Queen'

WESTERN MUGWORT An upright perennial with slim, toothed-edged silver-gray leaves. Small yellow flower plumes may form in summer; cut to maintain the foliage effect. May spread aggressively.

↑↔30in (75cm)

☀ Z4–9 (N)



SHRUB LARGE

Buddleja globosa

ORANGE BALL TREE This semievergreen shrub produces lance-shaped dark green leaves and globe-shaped, scented, bright orange flower heads in early summer. A reliable background plant for a border, it will also thrive beside a fence.

↑↔15ft (5m)

☀ Z7–9